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http://www.virtualstampclub.com/apstexas.html

The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388

T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3

MEETING CALENDAR

SEPTEMBER			OCTOBER		
2	NO MEETING - LABOR DAY WEEKEND		7	Juniors Board of Governors meeting Meeting & Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm
9	Juniors Board of Governors meeting Meeting & Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm	14	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm
10	Sat. Boursette & Library Day -- Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:30 am	21	Program: "Tin Can Mail & Narcotics Stamps" by Warren Crain	7:30 pm
16	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:00 pm	28	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm
23	BAG NIGHT	7:30 pm	29	Sat. Boursette & Library Day -- Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:30 am
30	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm	31	HAPPY HALLOWEEN	

11/04 - Jrs, BOG&G, Show&Tell: 11/05 - Sat.Boursette: 11/11 - Auction: 11/18 - Bourse: 11/25 - No Meeting - Thanksgiving

Labor Day - Sept 5 (Scott #1082)

Columbus Day - Oct 10 (Scott #2620-3)

Editors' Corner

At a recent Saturday Boursette, I was introduced to the wealth of internet sites devoted to Philately. Where could all this valuable information be found, I asked. In the pages of the Scott's catalogs, I was told. Wow!

The dealers listed in the catalogs all have websites where you can go to look at stamps, and can be invaluable in identifying unusual stamps. We also talked about many other sites of interest. Following are some of the links that can be used to identify stamps:

American Philatelic Society www.stamps.org Great for new issues and finding data.

American Plate Number Single Society www.apnss.org New Plate Number section also includes Scott # references.

American Stamp Dealer & Collector www.americanstampdealer.com Lots of articles on specialized stamp subjects (click top of page).

Ask Phil (Collectors Club of Chicago) www.askphil.org Articles about stamps, processes, and fakes.

Beyond the Perf www.beyondtheperf.com USA Philatelic extension site, with examples of upcoming stamp releases.

Eric Jackson Revenue Stamps www.ericjackson.com Good source for finding data (w/pics) of less known revenue stamps.

Websites for other stamp clubs or references:

Lake County Philatelic Society www.lcpshome.org Free online copies of their newsletters, with up-to-date subject matter.

Virtual Stamp Club www.virtualstampclub.com Great set of Links to other specialized stamp subjects, updates often.

Try these out for yourselves. They are fascinating! And come join us at the Saturday Boursette.

Lea Senghaas and Dora Roberts

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta & Richard Spies

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Mail your contributions for the Philatex to:
Philatex Editors
334 Olney Dr.
San Antonio, Tx 78209
Or email either of us.
lys@satx.rr.com dora.roberts@hotmail.com

Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1, facing Nacogdoches Rd.
Yearly dues are $15.00.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	John Clay
Vice President:	Nelda Greer
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chairman:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chairman:	Judy Grant
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Jack Virta
Assistant Auctioneer:	John Clay
Librarian:	Richard Rose

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

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Past President:	Jane K Fohn
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American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
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WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourses and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

Please wait until the end of the auction to pay for your purchases. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks are acceptable, made out to S.A.P.A.

Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Here we are; it's fall already. Little things are happening—like back to school. The stores are already thinking about Halloween. Then it'll be turkey time, plus watching the stores get ready for the big season.

While everything else happens, we go on buying and selling our stamps. We have fun looking for that special one that would complete a page or the very special one that we have waiting and looking out for many a year or two.

Our club purchases from the TPS books for the month of July came to a total of $900 worth. Thanks to you members, a great number of wanted stamps were found. Even new countries were started, and that means additional stamps are being entered on the want lists.

I hope everyone's summer has been a great one. Our south Texas weather has been hot and dry. Everyone has been praying for rain—even rain dances have been performed with no results yet.

As I said before when it does come, it will come in buckets.

Have fun to you all, and I'll see you next month. Hang in there.

John Clay

Program Notes

October 21, 2011 "Tin Can Mail" & "Narcotic Stamps" by Warren Crain

Warren tells me that these two subjects are just titles for more "SIL and CIL"

He says that the items will all be different from his other programs. Warren always outdoes himself and others with his programs. I am looking forward to being educated and entertained.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

We welcome our new member!

Carlos Torres #2817–collects interesting covers & stamps.

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

Sep 16-18 GREATER HOUSTON STAMP SHOW 2011 Annual exhibition and bourse of the Houston Philatelic Society at the Humble Civic Center, 8233 Will Clayton Pkwy (exit US Hyw 59 at Will Clayton Pkwy and go east), Humble TX.Features exhibits, 33-dealer bourse, beginners' booth, Sam Houston Philatelics auction, USPS substation, cacheted cover and show cancellation. TPA meetings scheduled on Sat as follows: Foundation Trustees at 8:30am; Board of Directors at 9:15am. Hours: Fri-Sat 10am-6pm, Sun 10am-4pm. Contact: Houston Philatelic Society, PO Box 690042, Houston, TX 77269-0042; or Denise Stotts, stottsjd@swbell.net.

Sep 23-24 TSDA DALLAS STAMP FAIR Bourse at the Richardson Civic Center, 411 W. Arapaho Rd, (net to Richardson City Hall), Richardson, Tx. Hours: Fri 11am-6pm, Sat 9am-4pm

Sep 30-Oct 1 TEXAS PRECANCEL CLUB FALL ROUNDUP Fall auction & bourse of the Texas Precancel Club at the Baymont Inn & Suites, 301 Capital St, Grapevine, Texas. Hours: Fri 9am-10pm, Sat 8am-5pm. Auction on Sat at 2pm. Contact: Katherine Foster, kh.foster@hotmail.com.

Oct 1-2 LAWTON-FORT SILL STAMP SHOW 46th annual bourse & show of the Lawton-Fort Sill stamp Club at the Center for Creative Living, 3501 Dr Elsie Hamm Lee Blvd. Show features children's and Boy Scouts' activities area. Hours: Sat 9am-5pm, Sun 10am-4pm. Contact: Bernard S Pawloski, Jr, obiks46@netscape.net

Oct 15-16 TSDA SAN ANTONIO STAMP FAIR Bourse at the Norris Conference enter, 4522 Fredericksburg Rd (at Wonderland Mall near NW I-410 and I-10, next to SuperTarget, lower level), San Antonio, Tx. Hours: Sat 10am-5pm,Sun 10am-3pm.

BAG NIGHT IS COMING!

September 23, 2011

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BLUE CHIP AUCTION—IMPORTANT INFORMATION

We will have our Blue Chip Auction on December 2, 2011. Our auctioneer, Jack Virta, needs to receive all lots for the auction by October 7th. This is because in order to publish the list of lots in the Nov.-Dec. Philatex, they must get to us (your Editors) by October 14th, to be mailed out on October 21st. The lots will be on display at the 1st and 3rd club meetings of November. Please also note that each lot for this auction must have a minimum catalog value of $15.00. As always, mail-in bids and other in-advance bids will be accepted. Contact Jack at 826-4826, or email him at <virta.jack@gmail.com>.

Philatex earns Vermeil Award

On Friday, August 5, 2011, SAPA President John Clay presented the editors of *The Philatex* with award certificates for their entry in the American Philatelic Society Chapter Activities Committee's 2010 Newsletter Competition. *The Philatex* received a total of 83 points out of 100, earning it a Vermeil Award. Points are awarded for content coverage and production quality.

This newsletter is for you, the members of SAPA. Dora and I were very pleased to get such a good review of our work, but the award is not the reason for doing the newsletter. We wish to provide you, our fellow club members, with information about what is happening in our club, and around the San Antonio area and in Texas. We hope to interest you with accounts of club activities and interesting information about stamps and collecting them.

We would really like to hear from you about what you like or dislike about this newsletter, or what features you would like to see added to it. It is our goal to make this newsletter suit your needs, and any input will be appreciated.

We wish to thank other members of the club who have contributed to *The Philatex* over the years. Pat Richmond does an excellent job getting people to give the programs and then writing about them! We get interesting sites for our members to explore on the internet from Fred Groth, our Treasurer, and excellent 'State of the Club' messages from John Clay, our President. Jack Virta, our Auctioneer, makes sure that the proper postage is placed on each newsletter envelope, and Richard Spies hand-cancels them down at the Institute of Texan Cultures Post Office. We would be happy to have contributions from you about things you are interested in, or if you have any questions about philatelic subjects, we would be interested in researching to answer them if possible.

We have enjoyed doing *The Philatex*, and hope to do it for many more years.

Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts

"Airmail for Juniors"
by Dr. Harry Greer
July 22, 2011

BEHOLD!!!—Dr. Harry at work!!!

Yes, he really does have THREE—COUNT THEM—THREE laptops before him. Plus, for those of you who do computer games, two joysticks, but I digress.

Dr. Harry Greer came in like gangbusters and set up his audiovisual laboratory in our very midst. He and Dr. Eric Shepherd played with extension cords, plugs, a projector and the projector screen while the rest of us just sat dumbfounded and awed—I might add.

Harry began his discussion with a poignant remark, "Today, most of the young people, and adults as well, live a life of ***passive observation rather than activity.***"

We owe it to our children and their futures to provide activities that have educational benefits, more social interaction and activities that promote learning the value of integrity. Stamp collecting is just that kind of hobby.

"**Why Airmail?"**

1. A good place to start.
    a. Many of the stamps are inexpensive.
    b. Lots of information is available.
2. A dramatic and colorful history.
3. It features famous people who performed extraordinary feats to be of service to others rather than becoming famous for drug use and cruelty to animals.
    a. Jack Knight, and the story of how he single-handedly saved the airmail service.
    b. Elrey Jepperson, whose manuals and charts allowed pilots worldwide to fly safely.
4. Accompanied by all of the most up-to-date scientific discoveries and inventions.

Proposed Junior Program

1. Start with a 20-minute program where someone would speak about the history of stamps.
2. Then they could work on the flight simulators.
3. One meeting they could set up a ham station in the parking lot and learn to get a radio license.
4. On the last Friday of the month, they would work on individual collections with a mentor.
5. Harry suggested that the appropriate age would be no younger than 12 years old.

When Harry was finished with this presentation, he invited the members to work with the flight simulators that he had set up. The only person that had nerve enough to do it was Jack Virta. However, we all enjoyed Jack's flight vicariously.

The program was a smashing success and all of us enjoyed his presentation. Thank you, Harry for your most enlightening and educational presentation.

Yours in philately, Patricia Richmond

Above: Owney's furry profile highlights his stamp.

Smithsonian National Postal Museum July Object of the Month: Owney

[Owney] has traveled the length of every railroad in the United States and has seen the inside and enjoyed the hospitality of more post offices than the oldest inspector of the service.

Hopkinsville Kentuckian, January 4, 1895

Owney

On July 27, 2011, one of the museum's most interesting objects was commemorated with a United States postage stamp. During his lifetime a scruffy mutt named Owney was the nation's most famous canine. From 1888 until his death in 1897 Owney rode with Railway Mail Service clerks and mailbags all across the nation.

Owney's story begins in 1888 with his attachment to the mail clerks and mailbags at the Albany, New York, post office. His owner was likely a postal clerk who let the dog walk him to work. Owney was attracted to the texture or scent of the mailbags and when his master moved away, Owney stayed with his new mail clerk friends. He soon began to follow mailbags. At first, he followed them onto mail wagons and then onto mail trains, beginning an almost decade-long story of travels far and wide. Owney's journeys took him across the United States, into Canada, and possibly Mexico. On August 19, 1895, as part of a publicity stunt for the town of Tacoma, Washington, Owney left that city on a mail steamer and spent the next few months traveling around the world. He docked back in at New York City harbor in late December, returning by train to Tacoma on December 29, 1895.

Above: Owney posed for a photograph with his Railway Mail Service clerk friends

Among the first to visit the dog upon his arrival in town was often the local reporter, eager to learn where the dog had been, and share his travels with readers. This far-traveled canine would have achieved fame for his travels alone. But he also gathered attention for his fashion sense. Postal workers were the first to attach tokens to the dog's collar, but soon just about anyone and everyone who had the opportunity to give Owney a little souvenir of his trip did so. Before long the poor dog was carrying so many tags on his collar that he could barely keep his head upright. His mail clerk friends began shipping excess tags back to the Albany post office, where the postmaster soon put them on public display. Postmaster General John Wanamaker had a special harness built for Owney to wear, so his tags could be spread out evenly all over his body. A writer for the *Brooklyn Daily Eagle* reported that "Nearly every place he stopped Owney received an additional tag, until now he wears a big bunch. When he jogs along, they jingle like the bells on a junk wagon."

By the spring of 1897 Owney was in poor health. He had been "retired" from traveling and was living with a postal worker in St. Louis, Missouri. But the trains and the dog could not be separated and by June he was again riding the rails. On June 11, 1897 Owney was in the Toledo, Ohio post office. As usual, he'd followed the mailbags into the office where he was warmly greeted by postmaster Tucker and clerks.

Above: As a writer for the Railway Mail Service clerk's newsletter, the "RMS Bugle", noted, it was almost impossible to get Owney to sit for a photograph unless he was able to sit on mailbags.

Owney had often seemed reluctant to let people look at his tags, and on this day that reluctance took a violent turn, attacking and biting a mail clerk. The postmaster called for the town's marshal, who shot and killed the dog. The Toledo clerks refused to bury their beloved mascot. Clerks across the country asked that the dog receive the honor they considered he was due by being preserved and presented to the Post Office Department's headquarters. Owney was kept on display by the Department, and then forwarded to the Smithsonian Institution in 1911.

Owney's travels continue to enchant new generations and finally, 123 years after Owney rode his first mail car, his place in America's postal history will be cemented with his appearance on a postage stamp. The stamp features a profile of Owney's face against a backdrop of a few of his many tags. Now Owney's fans can celebrate this most fascinating postal pup in a most postal way.

Written by Nancy Pope - July 2011 ***Article & image courtesy of the National Postal Museum***

http://www.postalmuseum.si.edu/owney/index.html http://www.postalmuseum.si.edu/museum/1d_owney.html